

Chapter 73-3

Su Meiqi was full of questions, but seeing that Su Zhe didn't look like he was going to give her answers, she awkwardly slipped away.

Meanwhile, the family doctor here was just wrapping up. Su Zhe came over just in time to hear Su Yao, on the verge of waking, cry out heart-wrenchingly: "Qingzhu!"

The entire room fell silent.

Then Su Yao woke up. She looked ahead in confusion, then stiffly turned her body toward Su Zhe. Those eyes were washed with tears again as she asked in a hoarse voice: "Brother, who exactly have I forgotten?"

She said through tears: "My heart hurts so much. She told me to remember, but I can't."

Sheng Yu had been taken to sleep by a servant, and Su Meiqi had also been sent away.

Only Su Zhe and the family doctor remained in the room.

Su Zhe sat there contemplating for a long while, finally sighing: "If you can't remember, then don't try to. Sooner or later, you'll remember."

"It's someone very, very important." Su Yao said, "I dreamed of the girl I met today. In the dream, Qinglin was holding her and saying, our daughter is Qingzhu¹, she should be like bamboo—unbending and unbreakable, forever verdant."

Su Zhe closed his eyes, suppressing all his sorrowful emotions, and told her rationally: "Your daughter is right here, isn't she? Sheng Yu is by your side."

Su Yao continued shaking her head, "Not Sheng Yu."

She suddenly grabbed Su Zhe's sleeve and asked: "Brother, do I have another daughter?"

Su Zhe: "....."

"That girl today." Su Yao gripped Su Zhe's arm tightly, hurting him, but Su Zhe didn't make a sound. Su Yao's state was on the edge of collapse, yet she tried desperately to stay lucid: "She looks so much like Qinglin, especially when she's angry, she really looks... she she she... I I I... Did she come to find me?"

"Don't be foolish." Su Zhe still said heartlessly: "That's Sheng Linlang's daughter. Isn't it normal for her to resemble Sheng Qinglin?"

"Sheng Linlang....." Su Yao murmured the name: "Sounds so familiar."

Su Zhe: "....."

Today Su Yao didn't remember Sheng Linlang again.

But after a long while, Su Yao suddenly said: "I remember now, she's Qinglin's older sister. I... I haven't visited her since returning."

"There's nothing worth visiting." Su Zhe gently coaxed: "Sheng Qinglin passed away so many years ago. If you go, you'll just stir up her bad memories. Better not to meet."

Su Yao was gradually persuaded.

But she asked repeatedly: "Do I have another daughter?"

Su Zhe patiently answered: "No, only Sheng Yu."

Footnotes:

¹ Qingzhu (青竹): This is a repetition of the name explanation from the previous chapter, emphasizing the significance of Xu Qingzhu's name meaning "green/blue bamboo" and its symbolic connection to her father Sheng Qinglin (whose name contains "Qing" 清) and the bamboo qualities he wished for her.